

Daily UK Party Leaders Mentions

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Nigel Farage

Nigel is on full gloat, while Keir clings on with a hunted look in his eyes

Guardian (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:15:07 GMT

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<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/local-elections-nigel-farage-gloats-keir-starmer-clings-on>

JASON GROVES: Reform is extending its reach while Labour loses votes to everyone, everywhere

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:14:58 GMT

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https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15800881/Jason-Groves-local-elections-analysis-Reform-Labour.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Elections 2026 live: 'I'm not going to walk away,' says Starmer; Reform makes gains and Labour faces defeat in Wales and Scotland

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DAN HODGES: Only one issue now unites each area of our divided kingdom: A deep, abiding, visceral hatred for Keir Starmer. If Labour MPs don't act, there will be only one outcome...

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The Red-Wall Labour MP summed up the mood. 'It's not carnage. It's f***ing carnage.' The results are still coming in. But it's not going to get any better. The pattern is set.

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Four things we learnt in the UK elections

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Early results are a blow to Keir Starmer and evidence that the political landscape is fragmenting

<https://www.ft.com/content/393fdc2e-53bb-4a52-a6cd-bc3531a2c2eb>

Local election results live: **Farage's** Reform delivers huge blow to Labour but Starmer vows not to quit

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Sir Keir Starmer has spoken this morning after Labour lost control of eight councils with pressure intensifying on the prime minister

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Farage tears apart Starmer's red wall brick by brick as Labour heartlands decimated

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Labour suffered bruising losses across its northern heartlands as Nigel Farage hailed a 'historic shift in British politics'. Will Labour have any strongholds left by the end of the day? Dan Haygarth explains

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/labour-red-wall-local-elections-2026-keir-starmer-reform-uk-b2972884.html>

Nigel Farage dodges questions on £5m gift from crypto billionaire

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:57:22 GMT

Reform leader irritated when asked about money from Christopher Harborne on day of party's election gains Election 2026 live: latest news updates Nigel Farage has repeatedly refused to answer questions about a personal gift of £5m he received from the billionaire Christopher Harborne, as the Reform UK leader sought on

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/nigel-farage-dodges-questions-5m-gift-crypto-billionaire-christopher-harborne-reform-uk>

Farage marks 'historic' political shift as Starmer insists he won't step down | ITV News - ITVX

ITV (Google News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:43:06 GMT

Farage marks 'historic' political shift as Starmer insists he won't step down | ITV News ITVX

<https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiaEFVX3lxTE1UaDEwSWZldzZYYVFLMnhabmFGQW9laW8yN0ZsYkVtSW5qdVV4MDRYSTluOXNIMmw1TIRjY3NMUENTcnMwVENYbGRMNTBqSnZsNERvb0FuS3Z1YVh6bnpOWjV5TGZudWIM?oc=5>

Reform UK up close

Financial Times (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:12:27 GMT

How Nigel Farage's party operates — as it sets its sights on power

<https://www.ft.com/content/31f3ef3b-7aa2-46e7-a1db-7acc0212c16b>

Starmer defies calls to quit after heavy Labour council losses

Financial Times (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 11:49:36 GMT

Nigel Farage's Reform UK makes gains in English local elections

<https://www.ft.com/content/8958faa6-cbde-499b-8016-b89ef857a22b>

Nigel Farage hails 'truly historic shift' as Reform UK surges in local elections – video

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 11:14:48 GMT

Party leader said the local election results had demonstrated a shift in British politics as Reform took its first council in Havering, east London. Speaking outside Havering town hall, Farage was asked about the £5m sum given to him by a Thailand-based crypto billionaire , a question he awkwardly shrugged off Ele

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/video/2026/may/08/nigel-farage-historic-shift-reform-uk-local-elections-video>

Reform ends Tories' 25-year control of Essex

BBC (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 10:58:15 GMT

Nigel Farage's party celebrates gaining Essex County Council.

https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c4g8pn108qlo?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

Reform surges in English local elections — follow the results

Financial Times (UK) · Fri, 08 May 2026 08:56:14 GMT

Nigel Farage's party has won about 300 seats in early results

<https://www.ft.com/content/63a73c94-a927-4683-be1a-9ed0e53442de>

Starmer vows to fight on as PM despite heavy local election losses for Labour

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Leader defiant in face of calls from some of his MPs to quit but admits 'results are tough, and there's no sugarcoating it' Election 2026 live: latest news updates Full results from England, Scotland and Wales Keir Starmer has vowed to fight on as prime minister despite early results in local elections showing his part

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/keir-starmer-local-election-losses-labour>

Sir John Curtice: First results shows how fragmented UK politics has become

BBC (UK) · Fri, 08 May 2026 08:13:16 GMT

Reform are the winners so far, with more results still to be declared.

https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/ce8p4yn448vo?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

Starmer to play into **Farage's** hands and announce new soft Brexit push

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 01:47:30 GMT

The Prime Minister is expected to deliver a speech in the wake of dismal local election results in which he will claim that closer links with the EU are needed to tackle the cost of living.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15799115/Starmer-play-Farages-hands-announce-new-soft-Brexit-push.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Keir Starmer

Sir John Curtice delivers blunt verdict on **Starmer** as Labour braces for election losses

Independent (Politics) · Thu, 07 May 2026 23:01:58 GMT

Sir Keir Starmer has "never been as popular" as his Labour Party, elections expert Professor Sir John Curtice said as he analyzed the prime minister's role in his party's poor polling ahead of the local elections.

<https://www.independent.co.uk/tv/news/election-results-keir-starmer-prime-minister-john-curtice-b2972679.html>

'**Starmer's** a good man, bad at politics, in a field of men with lesser morals but sharper political reflexes'

Daily Mirror (News) · Fri, 8 May 2026 13:05:41 +0000

The local election results are a crunch moment for Labour. The boat must change course now, or capsize. Whether it does so with its current captain, or a new one, is less important than its direction

<https://www.mirror.co.uk/news/politics/labour-starmer-local-elections-farage-37129862>

Labour face historic Scotland and Wales wipeout - with **Starmer** to blame - as Greens rack up seats and Reform run rampant in local elections

Daily Mail (Articles) · Fri, 08 May 2026 15:20:55 +0100

The Greens dealt a hammer blow by taking the mayoralty in deep-red bastion Hackney this afternoon - suggesting more misery to come in London later.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15799735/Curtains-Keir-Polls-close-elections-spell-disaster-Starmer.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ito=1490&ns_campaign=1490

QUENTIN LETTS: Sir Keir was asked how he was feeling. That 'how' should have been an 'if'... for the stony-eyed PM, emotional display is simply not in the repertoire

Daily Mail (Articles) · Fri, 08 May 2026 15:02:59 +0100

Sir Keir Starmer, open-collared, stony-eyed, insisted he was 'not going to walk away and plunge the country into chaos'.

https://www.dailymail.com/debate/article-15801275/quentin-letts-keir-starmer-feelings-nigel-farage.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ito=1490&ns_campaign=1490

Tough election results hurt but don't weaken my resolve, says PM

BBC (UK) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:20:16 GMT

Sir Keir Starmer says he takes responsibility after early results see Labour lose seats and Reform UK make ground.

https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cz62dwe30wdo?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

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London local election results LIVE: **Starmer** takes blame as Reform and Greens shatter Labour

City AM (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:03:03 +0000

Good afternoon and welcome back to the City AM liveblog. Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer has resisted calls for his resignation as he takes responsibility for what he described as a 'tough' set of local election results, as the Labour Party suffers from a Reform surge. 'I'm not going to walk away

<https://www.cityam.com/london-local-elections-live-starmer-takes-blame-reform-greens-surge/>

Four things we learnt in the UK elections

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Ukrainian accused of **Keir Starmer** arson attacks says he was offered £3,000 from Russian-speaking taskmaster to torch car

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 13:48:04 GMT

Roman Lavrynovych, 22, allegedly plotted to set fire to the car and two houses in north London last May on the promise of cryptocurrency from a Telegram contact with the pseudonym 'El Money'.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15801439/Ukrainian-accused-Keir-Starmer-arson-money-Russian-torch-car.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Local election results live: Farage's Reform delivers huge blow to Labour but **Starmer** vows not to quit

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ITV (Google News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:43:06 GMT

Farage marks 'historic' political shift as Starmer insists he won't step down | ITV News ITVX

<https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiaEFVX3lxTE1UaDEwSWZldzZYVFLMnhabmFGQW9laW8yN0ZsYkVtSW5qdVV4MDRYSTluOXNIMmw1TIRjY3NMUENTcnMwVENYbGRMNTBqSnZsNERvb0FuS3Z1YVh6bnpOWjV5TGZudWIM?oc=5>

Gilts gain as **Starmer** clings on after local election wipeout

Financial Times (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:36:52 GMT

Despite heavy losses, investors say results do not represent 'doomsday scenario' for prime minister

<https://www.ft.com/content/3ff804ec-7536-432b-b443-ce8c7b63fa9d>

Labour's better than expected thrashing may allow **Starmer** to cling on in No 10

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:15:56 GMT

Results are undoubtedly bad but expectations had been set even lower, and any potential challengers are quiet for now Elections 2026 – live updates Full results from England, Scotland and Wales As the local elections results rolled in, a trickle of voices were calling for Keir Starmer to quit – a couple of MPs, a trade

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/labour-local-elections-keir-starmer-cling-on>

POLL OF THE DAY: Should **Starmer** resign after Labour's heavy local election losses?

Daily Mail (Articles) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:12:33 +0100

Sir Keir Starmer acknowledged it had been a 'tough' night for Labour but said that 'days like this don't weaken my resolve to deliver the change that I promised'.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15800673/POLL-Starmer-resign-Labour-heavy-local-election-losses.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ito=1490&ns_campaign=1490

Does anyone on board know how to fly a plane? Labour's captain has lost control | Marina Hyde

Guardian (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 12:02:43 GMT

You never change the pilot halfway through a flight, says a clearly rattled David Lammy. Can't he see that his party is in a tailspin? A couple of days ago on a Swiss flight from Seoul to Zurich, a pilot experienced a medical emergency . Three doctors on board assisted, one of the other pilots assumed the controls, and

<https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2026/may/08/fly-plane-labour-lost-control-keir-starmer-david-lammy-pilot>

Voters have not only rejected **Starmer** but the leadership challengers to his Labour crown

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 11:50:38 GMT

Political editor David Maddox looks at how the election results have left Labour with even more questions about the leadership of the party

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/local-elections-starmer-labour-leadership-rayner-burnham-b2972951.html>

Starmer defies calls to quit after heavy Labour council losses

Financial Times (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 11:49:36 GMT

Nigel Farage's Reform UK makes gains in English local elections

<https://www.ft.com/content/8958faa6-cbde-499b-8016-b89ef857a22b>

UK borrowing costs waver as **Starmer** insists he will not 'walk away'

City AM (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 11:23:24 +0000

Government borrowing costs – which are reflected in changes in gilt yields – have edged lower as City traders were calmed by Sir Keir Starmer's insistence that he would not "walk away". Gilts were the best performing government bonds out of any G7 nation on Friday morning as 10-year yields dropped by around eight basis

<https://www.cityam.com/uk-borrowing-costs-waver-as-starmer-insists-he-will-not-walk-away/>

Brazen shoplifter swipes entire Mini Eggs display from supermarket

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 10:46:18 GMT

A shoplifter stole an entire Mini Eggs display from a supermarket, CCTV from the store shows.

<https://www.independent.co.uk/tv/news/crime-mini-egg-thief-video-south-wales-b2972953.html>

No 10 insiders answer your questions on how Westminster really works – from pressure on the PM to political infighting

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 10:28:51 GMT

In The Room hosts and former Downing Street insiders Helen MacNamara and Cleo Watson responded to readers' questions on Keir Starmer's leadership, Labour's struggles, Reform and the Greens, Westminster culture and what is really happening behind the scenes

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/labour-local-elections-results-starmer-reform-greens-in-the-room-b2972946.html>

Rebecca Long-Bailey slams 'out of touch' **Keir Starmer** for 'soul-destroying' local election results

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 10:00:24 GMT

Rebecca Long-Bailey has criticised an "out of touch" Sir Keir Starmer as she described Labour's local election results as "soul-destroying."

<https://www.independent.co.uk/tv/news/england-election-results-starmer-rebecca-long-bailey-b2972939.html>

Labour group leader calls for **Keir Starmer** to resign

BBC (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 09:40:44 GMT

Councillor Daren Hale says Keir Starmer has "failed to get the message across".

https://www.bbc.com/news/videos/czx248gyj8ko?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

Submit your questions: Can **Starmer** survive the local elections?

Financial Times (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 09:21:02 GMT

Take part in a live Ask an Expert Q&A with columnist and writer of the Inside Politics newsletter, Stephen Bush, and UK chief political commentator Robert Shrimsley

<https://www.ft.com/content/695dd4d9-c2f9-4b27-acce-8f40d528be29>

Keir Starmer says he will not resign despite 'tough' local election losses – video

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 09:15:25 GMT

Prime minister says he is 'not going to walk away and plunge country into chaos' and will lead Labour into the next general election, despite heavy early losses on Friday Elections 2026 – live updates Continue reading...

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/video/2026/may/08/keir-starmer-says-he-will-not-resign-despite-tough-local-election-losses-video>

Starmer vows to fight on as PM despite heavy local election losses for Labour

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<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/keir-starmer-local-election-losses-labour>

Rayner, Streeter or Burnham? The favourites to replace **Starmer** if he's forced to resign

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 08:50:08 GMT

Sir Keir Starmer has vowed not to walk away but he will face increased pressure after a nightmarish night for the Labour Party in the local elections

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/keir-starmer-resign-prime-minister-elections-labour-burnham-rayner-streetering-b2972836.html>

Defiant **Starmer** 'not walking away' after Labour suffers disastrous local election results

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 08:48:37 GMT

The prime minister vowed to fight on, saying: 'Days like this don't weaken my resolve to deliver the change that I promised'

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/local-elections-2026-labour-starmer-results-b2972850.html>

Labour hand Tory Brexit rebel David Gauke a knighthood to Conservative fury as **Starmer** continues to stuff the Lords

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 08:13:29 GMT

David Gauke, who was suspended by the Conservatives for opposing a no-deal Brexit, has been put forward for a knighthood by Sir Keir Starmer.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15799039/Labour-hand-Tory-Brexit-rebel-David-Gauke-peerage-Conservative-fury-Starmer-continues-stuff-Lords.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Keir Starmer's leadership on line after Labour's disastrous election night

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 07:03:50 GMT

No 10 prepares for battle as party loses seats in heartlands and control of councils in Hartlepool, Tameside, Redditch and Tamworth Election 2026 live: latest news updates Full results from England, Scotland and Wales Hartlepool once nearly triggered Keir Starmer's resignation; local election results overnight mean it

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/labour-disastrous-night-local-elections-keir-starmer-leadership>

Labour losses pile up in England local elections as Reform UK makes gains

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 06:01:30 GMT

Reform runaway winners in north-east, likely pushing Labour into opposition in Hartlepool, with other losses for Starmer in Chorley, Wigan, Redditch and Tamworth Election 2026 live: latest news updates Full results from England, Scotland and Wales The scale of the electoral challenge facing Labour has been laid bare as

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/labour-reform-uk-england-local-elections-2026-scotland-wales>

Partial results show losses for **Starmer's** Labour and wins for Reform UK in local elections

Independent (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 05:06:31 GMT

Partial results from local elections in England showed large losses for Prime Minister Keir Starmer's governing Labour Party and gains for the hard-right party Reform U.K. The votes are being widely seen as an unofficial referendum on Starmer, elected less than two years ago

<https://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/politics/keir-starmer-labour-reform-uk-london-england-b2972774.html>

Starmer to play into Farage's hands and announce new soft Brexit push

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Keir Starmer will face the cameras and take responsibility for Labour's local election drubbing in 'masochism strategy' inspired by Tony Blair

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 01:26:08 GMT

After a bruising night for his party, the Prime Minister will face the cameras on Friday morning.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15799105/Keir-Starmer-face-cameras-responsibility-Labours-local-election-dubbing-masochism-strategy-inspired-Tony-Blair.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Kemi Badenoch

UK local elections results: Greens beat Labour to Hackney mayoralty to secure first major win as Reform win council in **Badenoch's** county - live updates

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:16:49 GMT

LIVE UPDATES: Follow the results and reaction from the UK local elections across England, Scotland and Wales in the biggest test of public opinion since Labour's landslide win in the 2024 general election.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15797643/uk-local-elections-results-labour-green-reform-conservatives-live-updates.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

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Kemi Badenoch 'could face battle to hold her Commons seat' after Reform surges in Essex... but Tories hold ground in London and make gains in Harlow

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:05:36 GMT

Kemi Badenoch has bucked the trend against recent polls, all of which said the Tories were no-hopers in major councils like Wandsworth and Westminster.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15800969/Conservatives-Kemi-Badenoch-breakthrough-victories-Labour-Reform-London-battleground-councils.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

London local election results LIVE: Starmer takes blame as Reform and Greens shatter Labour

City AM (News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:03:03 +0000

Good afternoon and welcome back to the City AM liveblog. Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer has resisted calls for his resignation as he takes responsibility for what he described as a tough set of local election results, as the Labour Party suffers from a Reform surge. I'm not going to walk away

<https://www.cityam.com/london-local-elections-live-starmer-takes-blame-reform-greens-surge/>

John Swinney

Holyrood Election 2026: The count begins with **Swinney's** SNP likely to fall short of a majority...

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:16:51 GMT

The polls have closed and the counting has begun. By later today, we will know just who has come out on top in the Scottish elections as the results start dropping in...

https://www.dailymail.com/news/uk-politics/article-15792263/Holyrood-Election-2026-Counting-begin-9am-John-Swinneys-SNP-likely-fall-short-majority.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

Ed Davey

The 7 mistakes that are ruining your garden and could leave you with a £2,000 bill (including power washing and robotic lawn mowers)

Daily Mail (Articles) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:40:00 +0100

Liam Cleary, gardening expert at the Old Railway Line Garden Centre, in Brecon, told the Daily Mail: 'The costs can creep up quickly with these kinds of mistakes.'

https://www.dailymail.com/lifestyle/article-15791363/The-7-mistakes-ruining-garden-leave-you-2-000-bill-including-power-washing-robotic-lawn-mowers.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ito=1490&ns_campaign=1490

Nige is on full gloat, while Keir clings on with a hunted look in his eyes

Guardian (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:15:07 GMT

Local elections appear to signal end of two-party politics with five parties in the game in England It all panned out pretty much as everyone had expected. Nigel Farage was insufferably pleased with himself. Keir Starmer looked hunted while insisting he was going to remain prime minister for ever. Longer possibly. Kemi

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/2026/may/08/local-elections-nigel-farage-gloats-keir-starmer-clings-on>

Labour says it's lost Senedd election, and Eluned Morgan could be out as first seats declared

BBC (Politics) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:08:00 GMT

Deputy First Minister Huw Irranca-Davies says next Welsh government will not be formed by Labour.

https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cdrpxvz61vko?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

Family and listeners pay tribute after 'legend' BBC radio DJ dies aged 57

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 10:24:27 GMT

Tributes have been paid to local radio 'legend' Dave Llewellyn, who has passed away at the age of 57 following a brief illness.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15801089/tribute-legend-BBC-radio-DJ-dies.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

One of Britain's 'first gay dads' and his husband are charged with rape, sexual assault and modern slavery trafficking for sexual exploitation

Daily Mail (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 09:14:15 GMT

Barrie Drewitt-Barlow, 57, also the UK's first openly gay football club owner, and his husband Scott Hutchison, 32, will appear at Chelmsford Magistrates' Court in Essex today.

https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-15800779/Barrie-Drewitt-Barlow-Scott-Hutchison-charged-rape.html?ns_mchannel=rss&ns_campaign=1490&ito=1490

World Cup fans in China and India face broadcast uncertainty

BBC (World) · Fri, 08 May 2026 04:10:45 GMT

Broadcasters in the two countries have yet to reach deals with Fifa, just weeks before the tournament is due to start.

https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cp9py4k8mll0?at_medium=RSS&at_campaign=rss

Rhun Ap Iorwerth

Elections 2026 live: 'I'm not going to walk away,' says Starmer; Reform makes gains and Labour faces defeat in Wales and Scotland

Guardian (UK News) · Fri, 08 May 2026 14:08:23 GMT

Farage says Labour being 'wiped out by Reform in many of their traditional areas'; Greens win first mayoralty in Hackney 2026 election results: latest from local, Scottish and Welsh votes We're getting statements from some of the political parties now as we wait for results. For the Conservatives, party chairman Kevin

<https://www.theguardian.com/politics/live/2026/may/07/elections-2026-local-scotland-wales-reform-green-labour-conservatives-live-news-updates>

Mary Lou McDonald

— no mentions today —

Gavin Robinson

— no mentions today —